



CLIENT SERVICE AGREEMENT

TERMS, CONDITIONS & SCOPE OF SERVICES

Thank you for choosing Team Integrity Knowledge Center ("TIKC") to assist with your business certification, government contracting readiness, and entrepreneurial development needs. Please read this Agreement carefully before signing. By signing below, you acknowledge that you have read, understood, and agree to be bound by all terms herein.

SECTION 1 — PARTIES TO THIS AGREEMENT

This Client Service Agreement ("Agreement") is entered into between:

Service Provider: Team Integrity Knowledge Center ("TIKC"), an Illinois-based consulting firm located at PO Box 178172, Chicago, IL 60617.

AND

Client ("You" or "Client"):

Full Legal Name:

**Business / Entity
Name:**

Email Address:

Phone Number:

State of Formation:

Business Description:

Number of Owners /
Members: _____

SECTION 2 — CERTIFICATIONS REQUESTED

Client is requesting TIKC's assistance with the following certification(s) (check all that apply):

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Minority Business Enterprise (MBE) | ☐ Woman Business Enterprise (WBE) / WBENC |
| ☐ Small Business Enterprise (SBE) | ☐ Woman-Owned Small Business (WOSB) |
| ☐ HUBZone Certification | ☐ Economically Disadvantaged WOSB (EDWOSB) |
| ☐ 8(a) Business Development Certification | ☐ Disadvantaged Business Enterprise (DBE) |
| ☐ VOSB / Service-Disabled VOSB (SDVOSB) | ☐ Other: _____ |

SECTION 3 — SCOPE OF SERVICES

TIKC agrees to provide the following services on behalf of Client, subject to the terms of this Agreement:

- Review and analysis of Client-submitted documents for certification eligibility
- Preparation and assembly of certification application(s) based on information provided by Client
- Liaison and communication with certifying agencies on Client's behalf, as authorized herein
- Submission of completed, notarized applications to the appropriate agency portals or mailing addresses
- File monitoring at 30-day intervals during the 90-day document collection period
- Issuance of a Revised Checklist upon each file review cycle
- Representation at or coordination of any Agency-requested Site Visit, if applicable
- Filing of appeals or advocacy on Client's behalf in the event of a certification denial, where circumstances allow

IMPORTANT: TIKC's services are limited to the preparation, submission, and communication functions described above. TIKC does not guarantee approval of any certification. Final certification decisions rest solely with the applicable certifying agency. TIKC has no control over, and makes no representations regarding, agency timelines, criteria, or outcomes.

SECTION 4 — CLIENT OBLIGATIONS AND ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Client agrees to the following obligations as a condition of TIKC's services:

- Provide all requested documents within the 90-day document collection window. Failure to do so may result in delay, suspension, or termination of services without refund.
- Submit documents in PDF or Word (.docx) format only. Photographs, JPEG, PNG, or other image-only files are not accepted and will not be processed.
- Forward ALL communications, emails, letters, or requests received from any certifying agency to TIKC immediately upon receipt. Responding directly to a certifying agency without TIKC's involvement — for any reason — constitutes a material breach of this Agreement and automatically voids TIKC's representation and obligation to provide further services, without refund.

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- Provide accurate, truthful, and complete information. Client affirms that all documents and information submitted are authentic and lawfully obtained. Client understands that submission of false, misleading, or fraudulent information to a certifying agency may result in denial, debarment, civil liability, or federal criminal prosecution under 18 U.S.C. § 1001 and other applicable law. TIKC bears no liability for consequences arising from Client-supplied inaccuracies.
- Notify TIKC of any changes to business structure, ownership, or operations prior to or during any agency Site Visit. Any changes disclosed during a Site Visit without prior notification to TIKC will void TIKC's involvement and forfeit all fees paid.
- Sign applications before a licensed Notary Public and return notarized copies to TIKC promptly.
- Provide Site Visit availability upon request and cooperate fully with the certifying agency.

SECTION 5 — AUTHORIZATION TO COMMUNICATE ON CLIENT'S BEHALF

By executing this Agreement, Client expressly authorizes Team Integrity Knowledge Center, including its employees, agents, and representatives, to:

- Review, prepare, and submit documents in connection with the certifications identified in Section 2 above;
- Communicate verbally and in writing with certifying agencies, including state and federal agencies, on Client's behalf;
- Submit applications, registrations, and responses to agency inquiries related to the scope of services described herein;
- Respond to and manage agency correspondence, including requests for additional information, on Client's behalf.

This authorization is limited to the certification services described in this Agreement and does not constitute a general or unlimited power of attorney. This authorization does not permit TIKC to execute legal contracts, transfer funds, acquire property, or take any action outside the scope of certification consulting services. This authorization remains in effect for the duration of the engagement and automatically terminates upon written notice of termination by either party, or upon final resolution of all pending certification matters, whichever is later.

SECTION 6 — PAYMENT TERMS

- All services require payment in advance prior to TIKC initiating work. Services are non-refundable once work has commenced.
- A late payment fee of \$55.00 will be assessed for any payment not received by the agreed due date.
- Chargebacks: Client agrees not to initiate chargebacks or payment disputes with their financial institution for services rendered under this Agreement. In the event of a billing dispute, Client agrees to notify TIKC in writing within thirty (30) days of the transaction date and attempt resolution in good faith prior to escalating to any third party or financial institution. Unauthorized chargebacks may result in the pursuit of collection proceedings and recovery of legal fees incurred.
- Additional fees apply for: recreation of corporate documents (Articles of Incorporation, Operating Agreements, Minutes, Stock or Member Certificates, Stock Ledger, etc.), resume preparation, and any services requested outside the original scope.

SECTION 7 — LIMITATION OF LIABILITY

TO THE MAXIMUM EXTENT PERMITTED BY APPLICABLE LAW, TIKC'S TOTAL LIABILITY TO CLIENT FOR ANY CLAIM ARISING OUT OF OR RELATING TO THIS AGREEMENT — WHETHER IN CONTRACT,

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TORT, STRICT LIABILITY, OR OTHERWISE — SHALL NOT EXCEED THE TOTAL FEES PAID BY CLIENT TO TIKC IN THE THREE (3) MONTHS PRECEDING THE CLAIM.

TIKC SHALL NOT BE LIABLE FOR ANY INDIRECT, INCIDENTAL, CONSEQUENTIAL, SPECIAL, EXEMPLARY, OR PUNITIVE DAMAGES, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO LOST PROFITS, LOST BUSINESS OPPORTUNITIES, LOST CERTIFICATIONS, OR REPUTATIONAL HARM, EVEN IF TIKC HAS BEEN ADVISED OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGES.

TIKC is not responsible for: (a) agency decisions to deny, revoke, or delay certification; (b) consequences arising from Client's failure to comply with agency requirements or Client's own misrepresentations; (c) changes in law, regulation, or agency policy that affect eligibility; or (d) events outside TIKC's reasonable control, including force majeure events.

SECTION 8 — INDEMNIFICATION

Client agrees to indemnify, defend, and hold harmless Team Integrity Knowledge Center, its officers, employees, agents, and representatives from and against any and all claims, damages, losses, penalties, fines, costs, and expenses (including reasonable attorneys' fees) arising out of or related to:

- Client's submission of false, inaccurate, or fraudulent documents or information to TIKC or any certifying agency;
- Client's unauthorized direct communication with any certifying agency in contravention of this Agreement;
- Client's breach of any obligation under this Agreement;
- Any third-party claim arising from actions taken by Client in connection with the certification process;
- Any government investigation, audit, debarment proceeding, or enforcement action resulting from Client's conduct.

SECTION 9 — CONFIDENTIALITY

TIKC agrees to maintain the confidentiality of all non-public information provided by Client and to use such information solely for the purpose of providing the services described herein. TIKC will not disclose Client's confidential information to any third party, except: (a) as required by law or court order; (b) to certifying agencies as necessary to perform the services; or (c) with Client's prior written consent.

Client acknowledges that TIKC may retain copies of submitted documents for recordkeeping purposes for a period not to exceed three (3) years following termination of the engagement.

SECTION 10 — CANCELLATION POLICY

All payments rendered under this Agreement are non-refundable. Work begins upon receipt of payment and execution of this Agreement. Cancellation by Client at any point after commencement does not entitle Client to any refund, partial or full.

TIKC reserves the right to terminate this Agreement and suspend services immediately, without refund, upon: (a) Client's material breach of any provision of this Agreement; (b) Client's direct communication with a certifying agency without TIKC's authorization; (c) Client's failure to provide required documents within the 90-day collection window; or (d) discovery that Client has submitted false or fraudulent information.

SECTION 11 — DISPUTE RESOLUTION AND GOVERNING LAW

This Agreement shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the State of Illinois, without regard to its conflict of laws principles. Any dispute arising under this Agreement shall first be submitted to good-faith negotiation between the parties for a period of thirty (30) days.

If the parties are unable to resolve the dispute through negotiation, either party may pursue binding arbitration administered by the American Arbitration Association (AAA) under its Commercial Arbitration Rules, with proceedings to be held in Cook County, Illinois. The arbitrator's decision shall be final and binding, and judgment may be entered in any court of competent jurisdiction. Each party shall bear its own attorneys' fees unless the arbitrator determines that a party acted in bad faith, in which case fees may be awarded to the prevailing party.

Nothing in this section shall prevent TIKC from seeking emergency injunctive or equitable relief in a court of competent jurisdiction to protect its confidential information or intellectual property.

SECTION 12 — DISCLAIMER OF WARRANTIES

TIKC PROVIDES ALL SERVICES "AS IS" AND MAKES NO WARRANTY, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING ANY IMPLIED WARRANTY OF MERCHANTABILITY, FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE, OR CERTIFICATION APPROVAL. TIKC does not warrant that any certification application will be approved by the applicable agency. Client acknowledges and accepts that certification decisions are made solely by the applicable government or certifying agency and are outside TIKC's control.

SECTION 13 — ENTIRE AGREEMENT; AMENDMENTS

This Agreement constitutes the entire agreement between the parties with respect to its subject matter and supersedes all prior agreements, representations, and understandings, whether written or oral. No amendment to this Agreement shall be effective unless made in writing and signed by both parties. If any provision of this Agreement is found to be unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall remain in full force and effect (severability).

SECTION 14 — SIGNATURES

By signing below, Client acknowledges that they have read, understand, and agree to all terms and conditions of this Agreement, and that they are legally authorized to execute this Agreement on behalf of the business entity identified herein.

Client Signature

Date

Printed Name

Title / Role